HEXLEY CHEMICALS

Permit Standard: Work at Height

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1. Purpose and scope

This standard sets out what a request for its permit type must show before an Area Authority may issue the permit, and what follows the decision.

It is used by the Permit Coordinator or Area Authority who opens a review, by the Area Authority who decides it, and by the performing authority who requests the permit, as the Control of Work Policy describes.

Each permit type has its own permit standard. The five permit standards share one layout and many of the same sentences; they differ in what the permit type covers, in the requirements of section 4 and how section 5 reads them, and in the documentation, the writing that follows a decision and the reasons that sections 6 to 9 give. A request is always reviewed under the standard of its own permit type, and under the standard of its linked permit type where it has one; a requirement in one standard never applies to a request of another permit type unless the request is linked to it.

The standard applies to every request for its permit type, whichever channel it comes through.

2. What this permit covers

This standard covers work at height anywhere at Thornmere Works: work on pipework, insulation and cladding, tank roofs, building roofs and cable trays, and painting, from a scaffold, a mobile elevating work platform, a ladder, a fixed platform or rope access, wherever a person could fall.

Welding or cutting done at height needs a hot work permit too, linked to this one, and work on lighting or cable trays that are isolated needs an electrical isolation permit.

The permit type is Work at height.

3. Who requests

A request is made by the performing authority - the contractor's supervisor who will lead the job - through the channel the contractor works in: the site portal, the contractor app or scanned paper. The performing authority answers for the request and the documents attached to it.

The request gives the plant area, its hazardous area classification, whether the process unit there is operating or shut down, whether the work is indoors or outdoors, the permit type and any linked permit type, the work activity, the equipment tag, the size of the work party, the planned work hours and the answers its requirements read. The documents attached to it - a method statement, a task risk assessment, a gas test record or a rescue plan - describe the work.

A request for work at height gives the working height, the access method, the fall protection and the barriers, whether a scaffold is inspected where one is used, and outdoors the wind at the work position.

4. Requirements

Every requirement below must be Met for an Area Authority to issue the permit. Each requirement is stated once, in one sentence, and a request is screened against all of them, in this order:

1 **Risk assessment.** A task risk assessment for the job is attached to the request.

2 **Fall protection.** Fall protection is fitted, as edge protection or a harness clipped to an anchor.

3 **Scaffold inspection.** A scaffold used for access is inspected and tagged.

4 **Barriers.** The area below or around the work is barriered.

5 **Wind speed.** Outdoors, the wind at the work position is at most 12 metres per second.

A requirement is never met by a sentence in a statement, and is never waived.

5. Reading the requirements

Each requirement is Met, Not met or Not documented on the request as the Permit Rules read it. The latest revision of a request is the request; an earlier revision is never screened.

- A task risk assessment is the contractor's own assessment of the job's hazards and the controls against them, attached to the request as one of its documents. The requirement is met when the request records it attached, not met when it records that it is not, and not documented when the answer is blank.
- Fall protection is edge protection on the open sides of the work position, or a harness clipped to an anchor for every person at height. The requirement is met when the request records it fitted, not met when it records that it is not, and not documented when the answer is blank.
- Scaffold inspection is a follow-on question, decided by the access method. Any access but a scaffold meets it whatever else the request says. From a scaffold, it is met with the scaffold inspected and tagged, not met when it is not, and not documented when that answer is blank. A blank access method is not documented and asks for the access method alone.
- The barriers keep people out of the area below work at height and back from the edge of a dig. The requirement is met when the request records the area barriered, not met when it records that it is not, and not documented when the answer is blank.
- Wind speed is a follow-on question, decided by the work location. Indoors it is met whatever else the request says. Outdoors, it is met with a wind at the work position of at most the figure, in metres per second to one decimal as the Permit Rules convert it from miles per hour, not met above it, and not documented when the wind is blank. A blank work location is not documented and asks for the work location alone.

A requirement that is not documented names the answers it needs, so that the performing authority can give them.

A request with a linked permit type is screened under this standard and under the linked type's, and must meet both. The documents never decide a requirement. A gas testing sentence whose reading differs from the request's is flagged for the Area Authority, and the request's answer still decides.

6. Documentation to provide

When a request is returned to its requester, the performing authority must provide this documentation and send the request again with it: a task risk assessment for the job, the access method and the working height, the fall protection fitted, the scaffold tag where a scaffold is used, the barriers below the work, and for work outdoors the wind at the work position.

7. The permit document

The permit document goes to the performing authority when an Area Authority issues a permit under this standard. It names the request by its permit reference and permit type, says the permit is issued, and gives the plant area, the equipment tag, the work activity, the work party's size and the planned hours, with the working height, the access, the fall protection, the barriers and, outdoors, the wind. A linked permit type is named with its own controls. It asks the performing authority to stop work if the wind rises above the standard's figure, and to keep the barriers in place. The permit document carries no figure from a model.

8. The work party briefing

The work party briefing is written after the permit document, for the people who will do the work. It tells them in plain words what the job is, where it is, its hazards and the controls they must keep. For work at height it says how the work position is reached, that harnesses stay clipped on, and that nobody stands inside the barriers below the work. Where the permit depends on a linked permit, the briefing says so. The briefing never gives the suspension likelihood, the expected work hours or any other figure from a model, and never names any member of Hexley's staff.

9. Why these requirements

A fall from a few metres can kill, so every person at height is protected by edge protection or a harness clipped to an anchor, and a scaffold is used only once it has been inspected and tagged.

Tools and materials fall too, so the area below the work is barriered. Outdoors, a strong wind can push a person or a sheet of cladding off balance, so work at height stops above the wind speed that section 4 gives.

Process Safety owns this standard, reviews it every twelve months and issues any amendment as a new issue of this document, replacing every earlier issue.